MODULE 29 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

What changed: spotting a dated question

Every currency flag from this course in one place, and how to answer when a question looks out of date.

SECTION Exam skills COVERS All domains MODULE 29 of 35

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Cloud native moves fast. Much study material, and some questions, **describe a world that no longer exists**.

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The curriculum itself changed

BEFORE 24 NOVEMBER 2025	FROM 24 NOVEMBER 2025
Five domains	Four domains
Fundamentals 46%, Orchestration 22%	Fundamentals 44%, Orchestration 28%
Architecture 16%, Observability 8%	Architecture 12%, observability folded into it
Application Delivery 8%	Application Delivery 16%: doubled
Troubleshooting and debugging implicit	Administration, Troubleshooting and Debugging named

ON THE EXAM

Newer questions lean on commands, troubleshooting and delivery; fewer ask pure CNCF trivia.

Dated answers, current answers (1)

IF AN OPTION SAYS...	TODAY THE ANSWER IS...
Docker Engine is the Kubernetes runtime	containerd or CRI-O, via the CRI
Use PodSecurityPolicy	Pod Security Admission (PSP removed in 1.25)
SMI is the service mesh standard	The Gateway API, through GAMMA
Use OpenTracing for tracing	OpenTelemetry
kubectl run creates a Deployment	kubectl run creates one bare Pod
Stable APIs go 12 months after deprecation	Never removed within Kubernetes 1.x

ON THE EXAM

Each row is a trap in a question bank somewhere. Recognise the left column on sight.

Dated answers, current answers (2)

IF AN OPTION SAYS...	TODAY THE ANSWER IS...
Use kube-proxy IPVS mode for scale	nftables mode; IPVS deprecated in 1.35
Services are backed by Endpoints	EndpointSlices; Endpoints deprecated 1.33
Install the Ingress NGINX controller	Retired March 2026: move to Gateway API
Resources are immutable	In-place resize, stable in 1.35
Helm's --atomic flag	--rollback-on-failure in Helm 4
SA tokens are long-lived Secrets	Short-lived projected tokens

ON THE EXAM

Recognise the left column on sight, and know the current fact.

Recently stable features

FEATURE	STABLE IN	MODULE
ValidatingAdmissionPolicy (CEL)	Kubernetes 1.30	18
Native sidecar containers	Kubernetes 1.33	6
kube-proxy nftables mode	Kubernetes 1.33	13
Dynamic Resource Allocation (DRA)	Kubernetes 1.34	12
In-place Pod resize	Kubernetes 1.35	12
User namespaces (hostUsers: false)	Kubernetes 1.36	18

ON THE EXAM

1.37 (August 2026) is current; 1.37, 1.36 and 1.35 are maintained.

Nodes and runtimes

CHANGE	WHEN	MODULE
dockershim removed	Kubernetes 1.24, May 2022	2
Last release supporting containerd 1.x	Kubernetes 1.35	2
Kubelet refuses cgroup v1 nodes by default	Kubernetes 1.35	1
Kubelets up to three minors older than the API server	Current skew policy	11

ON THE EXAM

Upgrading past 1.35 needs containerd 2 and cgroup v2 on every node.

The wider ecosystem

PROJECT	CHANGE	MODULE
Knative	Graduated, October 2025	27
Helm 4	GA, November 2025; Helm 3 security fixes end February 2027	23
Kyverno, Dragonfly	Graduated, March and January 2026	18
OpenTelemetry	Graduated, May 2026	26
Cloud Native Buildpacks	Graduated, August 2026	2
Istio ambient mode	GA in Istio 1.24, sidecarless	16
kaniko	Archived by Google, June 2025	2

ON THE EXAM

Maturity levels change several times a year. Check cncf.io/projects the week before your exam.

How the documentation itself changed

- **Security framing:** kubernetes.io moved from the 4Cs to lifecycle phases: Develop, Distribute, Deploy, Runtime.
- **The official curriculum text** still names OpenTracing among CNCF projects. Teach and answer with OpenTelemetry.
- Both framings, and both names, may appear in questions. Know which is current.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A source that looks official can still be out of date. Dates matter more than logos.

If the options include the current answer, **choose it**. If they do not, **choose the best of what is offered**.

Answering a question that looks dated

- **Current answer offered?** Choose it. Exams are updated towards current facts, not away.
- **Only dated options?** Choose the one that is least wrong for the concept being tested.
- **Is it really about history?** 'What replaced PodSecurityPolicy' wants the history.
- **Test the concept, not the date.** KCNA rarely hinges on an exact version number.
- **Do not argue with the question.** Spend the time on the next one.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Know what changed, then answer what the question is really testing.

> A practice question asks how containers are started on the nodes of a current Kubernetes 1.37 cluster.

Which statement is accurate today?

A Docker Engine must be installed on every node

B The dockershim translates CRI calls for containerd

C Images built with Docker must be rebuilt first

D containerd or CRI-O runs them, through the CRI

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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Which statement is accurate today?

A Docker Engine must be installed on every node
Dated: Docker Engine has not been needed since 1.24.

B The dockershim translates CRI calls for containerd
Dated: the dockershim was removed in 1.24.

C Images built with Docker must be rebuilt first
Never true: Docker builds OCI images.

D containerd or CRI-O runs them, through the CRI
Current: CRI runtimes, with no shim.

THE SIGNAL

Anything requiring Docker Engine or the dockershim on nodes is pre-2022.

> On a Kubernetes 1.37 cluster, the team must give a running Pod more CPU without recreating it.

Which statement is accurate today?

A Resize it in place, via the resize subresource

B It is impossible: resources are immutable once set

C Edit the Deployment; that is the only way

D Only a VPA in Recreate mode can change it

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which statement is accurate today?

A Resize it in place, via the resize subresource

Current: in-place resize is stable since 1.35.

B It is impossible: resources are immutable once set

Dated: true only before in-place resize.

C Edit the Deployment; that is the only way

Works, but recreates the Pods through a rollout.

D Only a VPA in Recreate mode can change it

Recreate mode recreates the Pod, by definition.

THE SIGNAL

'Resources are immutable' is a pre-1.35 answer.

> A question bank from 2024 says OpenTelemetry is an incubating CNCF project. You are sitting the exam in late 2026.

What is OpenTelemetry's CNCF level today?

A Sandbox

B Incubating

C Graduated

D Archived

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is OpenTelemetry's CNCF level today?

A Sandbox

Never; it entered as incubating.

B Incubating

Dated: true until May 2026.

C Graduated

Current: graduated on 21 May 2026.

D Archived

That is OpenTracing, its predecessor.

THE SIGNAL

OpenTelemetry graduated; OpenTracing is the archived one.

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> A study guide recommends PodSecurityPolicy to stop containers running as root. The team runs Kubernetes 1.37.

What should they use instead?

A PodSecurityPolicy objects, with RBAC bindings

B Pod Security Admission labels at Restricted

C A default-deny NetworkPolicy

D A RuntimeClass for every Pod

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they use instead?

A PodSecurityPolicy objects, with RBAC bindings
Removed in 1.25; the objects no longer exist.

B Pod Security Admission labels at Restricted
The built-in replacement; Restricted requires non-root.

C A default-deny NetworkPolicy
Controls traffic, not how containers run.

D A RuntimeClass for every Pod
Chooses a runtime; does not enforce non-root.

THE SIGNAL

What replaced PodSecurityPolicy: Pod Security Admission.

Module 29 in five lines

- **New curriculum** since November 2025: four domains, 44/28/16/12; Delivery doubled.
- **Replaced:** dockershim, PSP, SMI, OpenTracing, IPVS, Endpoints, Ingress NGINX, --atomic.
- **Now stable:** sidecars, nftables, DRA, in-place resize, user namespaces.
- **Graduated 2025-26:** Knative, Dragonfly, Kyverno, OpenTelemetry, Buildpacks.
- **Current answer offered? Choose it.** Otherwise, the least wrong option.

Next: confusion pairs, the look-alike concepts the exam loves to put side by side.

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